COLORADO
Information Security
Governor's Office of Information Technology

CISP-001: Acceptable Use of State Data & Information Technology Resources

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Title	Acceptable Use of State Data & Information Technology Resources
Executive Sponsor	Jill Fraser, Chief Information Security Officer
Issuing Authority	Governor's Office of Information Technology (OIT)
Applies to	All public agencies as defined by C.R.S. 24-37.5-102(26) and contracted parties. Not intended to govern state IT resources made available for public use (e.g., public Wi-Fi in state facilities).
Instrument Type	Policy
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1. Purpose

This policy supports the State of Colorado Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) in achieving the requirements of the Colorado Information Security Act (C.R.S. 24-37.5-401, et seq.). It governs the acceptable use of the State of Colorado's data and information technology (IT) resources by public agencies and users.

2. Applicability

This policy applies to all public agencies as defined by C.R.S. 24-37.5-102(26) and contracted parties. This policy is not intended to govern the use of state IT resources made available for public use (e.g., public Wi-Fi in state facilities by members of the public).

3. Defined Terms

All CISP-specific terms are defined in the Colorado Information Security Policy - CISP Glossary unless otherwise defined in this policy.

4. Policy

All state IT resources and state data are the sole property of the State of Colorado, governed by applicable statutes, policies and technical standards. This policy governs all use of state IT resources and state data by any user.

5. Unacceptable and Prohibited Use of State Data and State IT Resources

As a user of state data or state IT resources provided by the State of Colorado, you must not:

- Use state data or state IT resources for commercial or personal financial gain.
- Use state data or state IT resources to participate in political activities.
- Forward state data to personal email accounts, except for emails or personal data related to the employee (e.g., state benefits, PERA, or course-completion certificates).
- Post state data to personal social media accounts.
- Access any social media account using state IT resources except as specifically authorized in this policy.
- Disclose or forward state data to unauthorized parties.
- Use state IT resources in a way that negatively impacts the confidentiality, integrity or availability of the IT resources.
- Use state IT resources to send, intentionally receive or access defamatory, discriminatory, harassing or pornographic content or communication.
- Use IT resources, including public-facing state IT resources, to engage in conduct violating any local, state or federal law or regulation, the State of Colorado Universal Policies, agency-specific policies, or the Colorado Information Security Policies.
- Use personally owned technology to access state data or state IT resources without obtaining explicit approval as described in the Use of Personally Owned Equipment section of this policy.
- Download, install, or access software or applications on state IT resources without authorization from your appointing authority.
- Take unauthorized, deliberate action that damages or disrupts a state IT resource; alters or degrades its normal performance; reduces established security controls; or causes it to malfunction.
- Access state data or state IT resources without authorization.
- Allow unauthorized individuals to access state systems or IT resources.

6. Acceptable Use

Internet, Network, System, Calendar and Email Accounts

State data, IT resources, the state network, internet, systems, and email accounts must only be used to conduct official state business. Examples of acceptable use include:

- Communication with business associates.
- Conducting research relevant to the user's work or agency needs.
- Obtaining relevant news/information.
- Job-specific training provided through a social media platform.
- Listening to applicable legislative hearings or committee meetings to fulfill the user's agency or work group's mission.
- Adding personal appointments to a state work calendar only to block time and notify a team of necessary absences.

All public agencies have the right to monitor and/or investigate user activity while using or accessing any state data or state IT resource, including the state network, internet, systems, calendar, or email account. Users have no expectation of privacy while using state IT resources; all electronic communications sent to and from state-assigned accounts are the

property of the State of Colorado and are subject to the Colorado Open Records Act (CORA, C.R.S. § 24-72-200.1, et seq.).

Social Media

Users may use state IT resources to access social media to obtain information related to their work or state employment. When expressly authorized by their appointing authority and in line with their duties, users may post to social media as a representative of their agency or the state. Public agencies may have their own more restrictive social media policies, which users must follow.

License Agreements / Copyright Compliance

State IT resources must be used in accordance with the terms of software license agreements or other copyright restrictions. Users may not access or store restricted copyrighted material using any state IT resource.

Remote Access, Authentication and Devices

Connecting to internal state data and state networks must be done through approved remote access processes. Direct access to the state network without using a virtual private network (VPN) and multi-factor authentication (MFA) is prohibited. Users may not remotely access state data or a state IT resource via a personal device unless expressly approved by the user's appointing authority (accessing email and calendar are exempted).

User Responsibilities for Account and Access Management

While OIT, technology providers, and agencies are primarily responsible for managing accounts and access, users have the following responsibilities:

- Account Credentials: Follow technical standards to create strong passwords; protect account credentials and prevent unauthorized use; avoid reusing accounts or identifiers; use unique passwords; never share credentials.
- Access Control: Report when data is transmitted insecurely or to unauthorized recipients to the user's manager and the OIT Service Desk to generate an alert for the CISO.

Security Awareness Training and Education

Annual security awareness training and education must be provided to all users, who must complete assigned training in a timely manner, follow the principles and practices covered, and report suspected security incidents or policy violations.

Use of Personally Owned Equipment

Agencies with personnel who have a direct business need to use a personally owned device must follow the exceptions process; the requesting agency is responsible for tracking approvals. Approved personal devices must be free from malware, protected by strong authentication, and kept current with operating system and software updates to state standards.

Protecting Devices and State Data

Users must take reasonable precautions to prevent the loss or theft of state IT resources or state data, and must immediately report any loss or theft of devices used for state business (including personal devices) to their manager and the OIT Service Desk (for consolidated agencies) or as specified by their non-consolidated agency's applicable policy.

International Access to State Data and IT Resources

User access to state data and state IT resources while visiting international locations must comply with Department of Personnel and Administration universal policy requirements. International user access to systems and data is prohibited by Criminal Justice Information Sharing (CJIS) and Federal Tax Information (FTI) compliance requirements. Access from, or transmission of state data to, high-risk countries on the State Department's International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) list is prohibited at all times.

7. Compliance

Annual Acceptance / Retention

This policy must be accepted by users at the start of employment and no less than annually thereafter. Agencies must:

- Provide a documented acknowledgment of this policy for users to read and sign before accessing state IT resources and data.
- Maintain a record of signed acknowledgments for appropriate retention periods.
- Require individuals to re-read and re-sign the policy annually, regardless of prior acknowledgments.

Impacts of Non-compliance

Failure of users to comply with this policy may result in, as applicable:

- Agency-level sanctions regarding state IT resources: restriction, deactivation, or suspension of the user's account, project, or system, or termination of employment.
- Referral to law enforcement.
- Termination of contract or assignment for temporary workers, interns, volunteers, contractors, or vendors.
- Loss of federal grant funding, fines, and penalties.

Non-consolidated agencies must have appropriate policies and/or procedures to ensure compliance with this policy and all other Colorado Information Security Policies.

User Privacy and Right to Monitor and Investigate

All state records stored on a state-issued or approved IT resource, with minimal exception, are subject to the Colorado Open Records Act (CORA, C.R.S. § 24-72-200.1, et seq.).

8. Exceptions

Any exceptions to this policy must be documented, justified, and approved in advance of implementation. Requestors must submit a Secure Configuration Exception Request.

9. References

- Colorado Information Security Act (C.R.S. 24-37.5-401, et seq.)
- Colorado Open Records Act (C.R.S. § 24-72-200.1, et seq.)
- State of Colorado Universal Policies
- Secure Configuration Exception Request in ServiceHub
- US Government ITAR country list
- Password & Account Management Requirements Chart
- Colorado Information Security Policy - CISP Information Security Glossary